# Risk Assessment Policy

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## Risk Assessment Policy

Policy Title: Risk Assessment

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, contractors, volunteers, and residents at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

## 1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to providing a safe environment for residents, staff, visitors, and contractors through effective risk assessment and management.

We aim to:

- Identify, assess, and control risks that could cause harm.
- Comply with the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974, Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999, and Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014.
- Ensure residents receive safe, person-centred care that respects their dignity, rights, and independence.
- Foster a proactive culture of safety and continuous improvement.

## 2. Purpose

This policy sets out the framework for:

- Completing and reviewing risk assessments.
- Managing risks relating to residents, staff, visitors, equipment, and the environment.
- Supporting staff in understanding their responsibilities in risk management.
- Ensuring regulatory compliance and best practice standards.

## 3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Residents – individual care-related risks (e.g., falls, choking, pressure ulcers).
- Staff – workplace risks (e.g., moving and handling, stress, exposure to infection).
- Environment – risks in communal areas, resident rooms, and outdoor spaces.
- Operations – fire safety, safeguarding, medication, security, and emergency planning.

## 4. Roles and Responsibilities

**Registered Manager:**

- Has overall responsibility for ensuring risk assessments are in place and effective.
- Ensures staff are trained and competent in risk assessment processes.
- Reviews high-level risks and implements corrective actions.

**Supervisors / Team Leaders:**

- Carry out risk assessments within their area of responsibility.
- Monitor staff compliance with safe working practices.
- Ensure control measures are followed and updated as needed.

**All Staff:**

- Follow risk assessments and safe systems of work.
- Report hazards or changes in risk immediately.
- Support residents in risk-related decision-making, balancing safety with independence.

## 5. Risk Assessment Process

Risk assessments must follow the 5 Steps to Risk Assessment approach:

- Identify hazards – anything with the potential to cause harm.
- Decide who might be harmed and how – residents, staff, visitors, contractors.
- Evaluate risks and decide on control measures – reduce likelihood and/or severity.
- Record findings and implement actions – document assessment and put measures in place.
- Review and update – at least annually, or sooner if circumstances change (e.g., incident, new equipment, change in resident condition).

## 6. Types of Risk Assessments

- Resident Care Risk Assessments – falls, nutrition, skin integrity, choking, mobility, medication.
- Health & Safety Risk Assessments – fire safety, manual handling, hazardous substances (COSHH), infection prevention.
- Workplace Risk Assessments – stress, lone working, night shifts.
- Environmental Risk Assessments – communal areas, kitchens, bathrooms, gardens.
- Special Risk Assessments – outings, use of equipment, emergencies, safeguarding concerns.

## 7. Resident Involvement

- Residents and/or their representatives will be involved in individual care risk assessments.
- Risk assessments will consider residents' rights, choices, and independence.
- Positive risk-taking will be supported where safe and appropriate.

## 8. Training and Awareness

- All staff will receive training in risk assessment, health and safety, and safe systems of work.
- Refresher training provided annually or as required.
- Managers will receive additional training in risk management and audit.

## 9. Monitoring and Review

- Regular audits of risk assessments carried out by management.
- Incident reports reviewed to identify emerging risks or failures in control measures.

- Action plans developed for continuous improvement.
- CQC and local authority requirements monitored for compliance.

## 10. References

- Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974
- Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)
- HSE Guidance on Risk Assessment

## 11. Related Policies

- Health & Safety Policy
- Infection Prevention & Control Policy
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Fire Safety Policy
- Business Continuity & Emergency Planning Policy
- Quality Assurance & Audit Policy

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